PIETRO **ZECCA**

Washington, D.C.
pz1361a@american.edu
Data Analysis Portfolio (GitHub)

Economics and policy researcher with advanced R skills and hands-on experience in data cleaning, regression analysis, web scraping, and reproducible research. Co-author of policy research on development finance, with experience in literature reviews, data visualization, and writing for policy audiences.

EDUCATION

EXPECTED DECEMBER 2026: AMERICAN UNIVERSITY (Washington, D.C.)

- **Master of Arts in International Development** – School of International Service. Recipient of the **SIS Dean's Graduate Assistantship Award** based on exceptional academic achievement and potential. **GPA: 3.96/4**.
- Graduate Certificate in **Social Innovation for Global Impact**.
- **Relevant Coursework**: Innovation for Social Impact, International Affairs Stats & Methods, Economic Development, Project Design Monitoring & Evaluation, Data Analysis, International Economics, GIS Applications in Empirical Economics.
  Practicum: Planning for Conflict & Climate Migrants (International Organization for Migration).
- **Graduate Assistant** to Professor C. Austin Davis: Essentials of Economics & Data Analytics (Fall 2025, Fall 2026), International Affairs Stats & Methods (Spring 2026).

2024: BOCCONI UNIVERSITY (Milan, Italy)

- MSc in **Economics and Management of Government and International Organizations**. Final grade: **110/110**.
- **Dissertation**: "*Cluster competitiveness & sustainable development: the Lombardy Energy Cleantech Cluster*". Applied Porter's Diamond framework and stakeholder interviews to assess how a regional clean energy cluster drives competitiveness.
- **Relevant Coursework**: Quantitative Methods for Social Sciences, Economics & Policy of Global Markets, Management of International Organizations & NGOs, Policy Analysis & Evaluation, Long-Term Investments & Public-Private Partnerships, Social Innovation.
- Selected as graduate **exchange student** based on academic achievement at the **University of Southern California** (Sol Price School of Public Policy, January – May 2023).

2021: BOCCONI UNIVERSITY (Milan, Italy)

- BSc in **International Economics and Management**. Final grade: **101/110**.
- **Dissertation**: "*Boston's plan towards the smart city: a case study*". Applied the Giffinger smart city framework across its six dimensions.
- **Relevant Coursework**: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Statistics, Mathematics (General & Applied), Computer Science, Corporate Finance, Financial Markets and Institutions, European Economic Policy, International Economics, Business Strategy, Geopolitics.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MAY – AUGUST 2026: INTERN, Observer Research Foundation America (Washington, D.C.)

- **Co-authored** a background **paper on development finance** and wrote policy comments for the Energy & Climate and Global Economics & Development teams (see Publications).
- **Cleaned and analyzed** cross-country energy and finance **data in R and Excel**; produced **charts** for research papers and built an **interactive dashboard** in Flourish.
- Conducted **literature reviews** on development finance, debt sustainability, and the clean energy transition.
- Supported **events** by preparing background **materials**, drafting summaries, reaching out to **guests** and managing registration.

MAY – JULY 2025: RESEARCH ASSISTANT, Samuel Hall (Nairobi, Kenya)

- Conducted **desk research and literature review**, contributing to the inception and final **evaluation reports** by the MEAL team.
- Supported **data collection and analysis** by reviewing and coding **Key Informant Interviews** against evaluation criteria, and assisted in conducting interviews.
- Prepared project-related outputs, including **presentations**, annexes, and contextual analyses, ensuring alignment with **evaluation frameworks** and donor requirements.

JANUARY – OCTOBER 2024: BUSINESS MANAGEMENT INTERN, Piana Nonwovens (Cartersville, GA)

- Conducted comprehensive **market research** and analysis to inform executive decision-making.
- Developed **strategic documents** to support business operations, including **workflow optimization**, **logistics**, inventory management, **supplier evaluation**.
- Collaborated with **cross-functional teams** to optimize operational efficiency.

SEPTEMBER – DECEMBER 2023: PROJECT MANAGEMENT INTERN, A2A (Milan, Italy)

- Assisted in digital HR transformation projects, enhancing **organizational integration**.
- **Coordinated** among **project stakeholders** to ensure alignment and **goal achievement**.
- Applied **project management methodologies** to drive successful project outcomes.

MAY – AUGUST 2023: INTERN, Embassy of Italy in the U.S.A. (Washington, D.C.)

- Intern in the Office for **Economic, Trade and Scientific Affairs**.
- Carried out **research and analysis** on US economic and trade policies, **data processing** activities and engaged in the organization of **events**.
- Reported on US Congress hearings and advanced **drafting skills** by writing briefs.

PUBLICATIONS

- Das, U. and Zecca, P. (2026). "Overcoming the Absorption Dilemma – The Need for Deployment Sustainability Analysis in an Era of Aid Contraction." ORF America Background Paper No. 40, September 2026.
- Zecca, P. (2026). "Why Industrial Decarbonization Requires Clusters." ORF America Comment.
- Zecca, P. (2026). "Can Italy Become India's Gateway to Europe?" ORF America Comment.
- Research contributions: data analysis and visualization for "Leveraging Strategic Assets: Attracting Financing in the Developing World in a Post-Aid Era" (ORF America, 2026); "IBSA+Indonesia Energy Transitions Dashboard" (ORF America, 2026).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **R (advanced):** tidyverse (dplyr, tidyr, purrr, ggplot2), web scraping (rvest), API integration, custom functions, large dataset manipulation. **Portfolio**: github.com/pietro1361/data-analysis-portfolio.
- **Reproducible research:** Quarto, R Markdown, Git/GitHub.
- **Other software:** Stata (coursework), Python (introductory, via ArcGIS Pro), Excel (advanced formulas, pivot tables), Flourish, Canva, Microsoft Office.
- **Methods:** regression analysis, hypothesis testing, descriptive statistics, data cleaning and merging, GIS, data visualization.
- **Languages:** Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (upper intermediate), German and French (beginner).

CERTIFICATIONS

- Introduction to Behavioral Science in Public Policy, The World Bank (March 2025).
- Reproducible Research Fundamentals, The World Bank (April 2025).
- Manage Successful Field Research, The World Bank (December 2025).
- Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research, CITI Program (January 2026).